# Century Spice Road

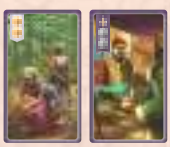
*Centuries ago, the spice trade was the most important market in the world. It established and destroyed empires, compelled men to explore the far corners of the earth, and led to the discovery of new worlds. At that time, the value of spices even rivaled that of gold! In the old days, they carried a sense of mystery and allure. Spice merchants would weave fantastic tales of danger to reach these spices in hopes of selling their wares at high prices. In later centuries, the demand on spices became so great, that those who controlled the spices generated immense wealth and renown. It is at this time, you find yourself leading your caravan across the eastern lands to the Mediterranean Sea in search of wealth and fortune. As a caravan leader, your journey begins on the Spice Road.*

## Game Setup




**To set up a game of *Century*, follow these steps in order:**

1. Shuffle the Point cards (orange back) to form a deck (A), then draw 5 cards and place them face up in a row to the left of that deck (B).
2. Place a pile of gold coins equal to the number of players x2 above the first *(leftmost)* point card (C). Then place a pile of silver coins equal to the number of players x2 above the second Point card (D).
3. Among the Merchant cards (purple back) (E), there are 10 cards with a purple border on the face up side. These are the starting cards. Among them, each player gets one 'Create 2' and one 'Upgrade 2' card to form their starting hand, as shown here. Any remaining starting cards are returned to the box.



*Create 2* *Upgrade 2*

4. Shuffle the remaining Merchant cards to form a deck (E). Draw 6 cards and place them face up in a row to the left of that deck (F).
5. Spices are represented by cubes. Separate them by color and place them into the bowls (G). **Note:** Make sure the order of the colored cubes matches the order shown above: Yellow (Turmeric) ▶ Red (Saffron) ▶ Green (Cardamom) ▶ Brown (Cinnamon).
6. Take a Caravan card (grey back) for each player in the game, being sure to include the card with the first player symbol on it, shuffle them and deal each player one card in front of them (H). The player with the first player symbol on their Caravan card is the first player.
7. Place yellow and red cubes according to the table below on each player's Caravan card (I).
   - 1st player gets 3 yellow cubes
   - 2nd player gets 4 yellow cubes
   - 3rd player gets 4 yellow cubes
   - 4th player gets 3 yellow and 1 red cube
   - 5th player gets 3 yellow and 1 red cube

## Taking a Turn

*Century Spice Road* is played over a series of rounds. Each player will take one turn each round *(starting with the first player and going clockwise)*.

On a player's turn, they must perform 1 of the following actions:

- **Play:** Play a card from your hand
- **Acquire:** Acquire a Merchant card
- **Rest:** Take all previously played cards back to your hand
- **Claim:** Claim a Point card

## Play

To play a card from your hand, place the card face up in front of you and apply the card's effect. There are 3 types of Merchant cards that can be played in this way:

### Spice Cards

When playing a Spice card, take the number and color of cube(s) shown on the card (A) from the bowls and place them on your caravan.

***Example:*** *This player would place 1 red cube and 1 yellow cube on their caravan.*



## Upgrade Cards



When playing an 'Upgrade 2' card, you **MAY** upgrade a cube on your caravan 1 level and then upgrade a cube 1 level again. It is not mandatory to upgrade all cubes from an upgrade card.

***Example:*** *You may upgrade a yellow cube to a red cube and then upgrade another yellow cube to a red cube, or you can upgrade a yellow cube to a red cube and then upgrade that red cube to a green cube.*



*Cube upgrade levels*

## Trade Cards

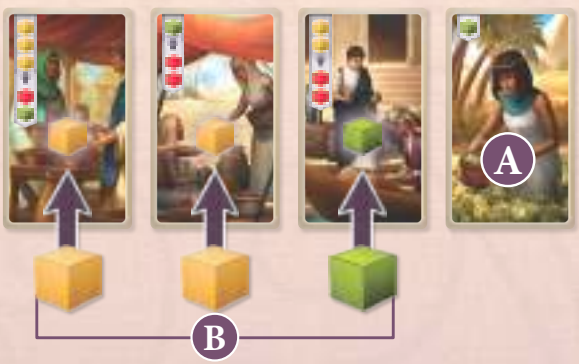



When playing a Trade card, return the number and color of cube(s) shown above the arrow (A) from your caravan to the bowls, then take the number and color of cube(s) shown below the arrow (B) from the supply and add them to your caravan. A trade can be done any number of times in a row as long as you have the appropriate cubes available.

***Example:*** *Tom has 6 yellow cubes and plays a Trade card that allows him to trade 2 yellow cubes for 1 green cube. Tom may trade 2, 4, or 6 yellow cubes for 1, 2, or 3 green cubes.*

## Acquire

To acquire a Merchant card, first pay for it by placing ANY cube from your caravan on each Merchant card to the left of the card you are acquiring and then take that Merchant card into your hand. **Note:** When acquiring the leftmost Merchant card, no cubes are placed. The card is free.




***Example:*** *Tom wants to acquire the fourth Merchant card in the row (A), so he places 1 cube on each of the 3 cards to the left of it (B).*

When acquiring a Merchant card and placing it in your hand, any cubes that were on that card are placed on your caravan. After acquiring a Merchant card, fill the empty slot by sliding the cards to the left, creating an empty slot just to the left of the merchant deck; then draw a card from the deck to fill that empty slot.

## Rest

To rest, take all of the cards you played face up in front of you back into your hand *(This allows players to build their Merchant cards hand, a game mechanism called "deck-building", as the game evolves).*

## Claim

To claim a Point card, you must have all of the cubes shown on the point card in your caravan. Return those cubes to the bowls. Take the Point card and place it face down in front of you. After claiming a Point card, fill the empty slot by sliding the cards to the left, creating an empty slot just to the left of the point deck; then draw a card from the deck to fill that empty slot. If you claim the leftmost or second leftmost Point card, take one gold or silver coin respectively from above that card. If you take the last gold coin, slide the pile of silver coins so it is now above the leftmost Point card.

## Caravan Limit

At the end of a player's turn, if that player has more cubes on their caravan than it can hold, they must return cubes of their choice to the bowls until they reach their limit. A player's caravan can hold up to 10 cubes.

## Cube Limit

The cube supply is not limited. If a supply is exhausted, use a substitute material *(e.g. players run out of yellow cubes and use candies to track additional yellow cubes).*

## Game End

Once a player has taken their 5th Point card *(or 6th in a 2-3 player game)*, the game will end after players finish out the current round of play. At that point, each player counts all their points on their Point cards, their gold/silver coins, and the remaining cubes on their caravan. Each gold coin is worth 3 points. Each silver coin is worth 1 point. Each non-yellow cube is worth 1 point.

The player with the most points wins. If there is a tie, the last player to take a turn wins the tie.

## Credits

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